CHECKS AND BALANCES (PRESIDENTIAL FORM)

Executive Branch **(President carries out laws)** 	**Checks on the Legislative Branch** Can propose laws Can veto laws Can call special sessions of Congress Makes appointments Negotiates foreign treaties	**Checks on the Judicial Branch** Appoints federal judges Can grant pardons to federal offenders
Legislative Branch **(Congress makes laws)** 	**Checks on the Executive Branch** Can override President's veto Confirms executive appointments Ratifies treaties Can deciare war Appropriate money Can impeach and remove President	**Checks on the Judicial Branch** Creates lower federal courts Can impeach and remove judges Can propose amendments to overrule judicial decisions Approves appointments of federal judges
Judicial Branch **(Supreme Court interprets laws)** 	**Checks on the Executive Branch** Can declare executive actions unconstitutional	**Checks on the Legislative Branch** Can declare acts of unconstitutional

Approaches to the study of Government

Studying governments from different approaches help us to understand government from its evolution to its performance in the contemporary times. The approaches to study the Government are...

1. Comparative-Historical Approach

This approach studied the western political institutions from ancient to modern times, this approach is descriptive in nature, Aristotle, Montesque and Locke adopted this approach to study and analyse governments in those days. For instance before writing his monumental work politics Aristotle studied 158 constitutions. Montesque studied the working of the British constitution and came to the conclusion that the stability of British constitution was due to the adherence to the principle of separation of powers.

2. Legal-Institutional Approach

Scholars like ***Bentham, Austin*** and ***Dicey*** adopted this approach, This approach focuses on formal legal structure of political institutions. They helped to develop certain theories which explain the relationship and interconnection between government and Law. ***Bentham*** is the distinguished legal reformer in England Likewise ***Austin*** provided a legal base to sovereignty which is indivisible, inalienable and absolute. ***A.V.Dicey*** judged the government on the basis of law and its applicability to different branches of government.

3. Political Economy Approach

This approach deals with economic aspects of the government which gives economic interpretation of politics also deals with role of market, mode of production and delivering goods to the society. This approach is classified into liberal political economy and the Marxist political economy approach.

4. Political Sociology Approach

This approach derived its ideas from sociology and anthropology also known as systems approach. Political sociology

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